

Borja Aran - Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Results-driven Software Engineer with strong expertise in building scalable real-time systems and complex features. Owned end-to-end delivery of multiple high-impact initiatives, including detailed work breakdowns, accurate planning, stakeholder management, and technical mentoring. Excelled at empowering team members to take full feature ownership while consistently delivering high-quality solutions on tight deadlines in fast-paced environments.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer

ASML US by TOPIC Embedded Systems

January 2025 - Present, Best, NL

- Developed a throughput mode for the alignment scan of XT machines, reducing alignment scan times by 30%.
- Mentored 2 engineers on domain knowledge and architecture decisions, empowering them to independently design and implement solutions while reducing senior dependency by 50% and fostering a collaborative engineering culture.
- Owned end-to-end delivery of multiple high-impact features: performed detailed breakdowns, created accurate plans and deadlines, proactively managed key stakeholders, and consistently delivered on time with high quality.

Software Engineer

Stellar Entertainment

October 2022 - November 2024, Utrecht, Netherlands

- Designed and implemented core game systems from scratch (e.g., Game Modes), building modular and scalable architecture that enabled designers to rapidly prototype and iterate on content, reducing content production time by ~40%.
- Developed multiplayer functionality from initial planning to deployment using EOS backend and Unreal Engine, establishing stable and responsive networking for player interactions.
- Planned, estimated effort, and prioritized features and user stories for game systems, content, and live operations to ensure on-time delivery.

Junior Software Engineer

Circonium Studios

October 2022 - October 2023

- Owned core gameplay mechanics and systems in Unreal Engine from design through optimization, including full ownership of FMOD audio implementation and UI frameworks, resulting in smooth, responsive gameplay and high-quality player feedback.
- Coordinated a 40-person cross-functional team as the primary technical point of contact, aligning engineering, design, and art efforts to meet sprint goals and maintain consistent project momentum in a fast-paced indie environment.
- Drove performance optimization and debugging across gameplay systems to deliver polished, immersive player experiences.

Lead Software Engineer

Klever

April 2022 - July 2022

XR Start up

- Served as the sole Lead Software Engineer and only programmer in an early-stage XR startup, owning the complete software architecture and technical roadmap for immersive XR applications.
- Coordinated and led 3D asset production in close partnership with the sole artist, establishing efficient modeling pipelines that delivered optimized, high-performance 3D assets for real-time XR experiences.
- Collaborated closely with business stakeholders and founders in an early-stage XR startup to translate product requirements into technical specifications, prioritized features, and aligned development efforts.

EDUCATION

Masters in Software Engineering on Game Development

Universidad Complutense • Madrid, SP • 2022

- Winning [PlayStation Talents: Best Original Idea](#) with Khemia

Computer Engineering

Universidad Carlos III • Madrid • 2021

- Erasmus+ scholarship at Politechnika Lubelska (Lublin, Poland) - 2019

SKILLS

C++, C, Python, Linux, Git, Perforce, Debugging, Performance Optimization, Networking, Unreal Engine 5, Math
